GROWTH MEMO | JERRY

Satisfied Switchers, Silent Growth: Turning One-Time Savings into Renewals and Referrals

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The question, and why it matters

Jerry's goal is to grow from 5M to 50M customers. The cheapest customers to win are the ones Jerry already has (renewals) and the ones they bring in (referrals). Before pulling any data, I asked: **do customers who save money with Jerry stay with Jerry and bring others to it?** Small-scale user research suggests the answer is "not reliably," for reasons that look fixable.

What I heard from real users (informal interviews, November 2026)

Who	What they said	Signal
Current customer, switched via Jerry	Found Jerry **through ChatGPT**. Compared quotes, switched, **saves about $100**. Opens the app **only at renewal**. Finds the **driving score annoying**. Would recommend it because "it's cheap."	Strong value at the switch moment, weak relationship between renewals
Same customer, today	**Locked out**: the account is tied to a phone number he deactivated, and he could not log in with email.	Account recovery may block renewals
Trial user (a friend)	Got a GEICO quote on Jerry, then found **GEICO direct was cheaper**, bought direct, and told another friend to do the same.	Price-trust risk and negative word of mouth
5 to 8 people told about Jerry	Reaction: "nice, I'll look into it." Belief: "my insurance is fine." **None downloaded.** The customer only mentioned it; no link or reward.	Word of mouth does not convert to action
Same customer, on new verticals	Would use renters or home insurance **if Jerry recommends the same way** it does for auto.	Cross-sell demand exists if the experience carries over

Limits: *this is a small, informal sample of international working professionals in San Diego. These are hypotheses to test with Jerry's data, not conclusions.*

Hypotheses and how I would test them

#	Hypothesis	Test with data
H1	**Phone-only login quietly lowers renewal.** Users who change numbers cannot get back in at renewal and buy elsewhere.	Renewal rate by login method; failed logins and support tickets in the 30 days before term end
H2	**One price mismatch breaks trust.** When a carrier's direct price beats Jerry's, users leave and tell friends.	Quote-to-bind rate by carrier; drop-off after quote view; survey users who did not bind
H3	**There is no reason to open Jerry between renewals,** and the driving score feels like surveillance, not value.	Monthly active users between renewals; driving-score opt-out rate; renewal rate by engagement level
H4	**Referrals stall at the conversation.** "It's cheap" is said, but nothing makes it easy to act.	Invites per active user, invite-to-quote-to-bind funnel, and referred users' 12-month retention
H5	**Savings at the switch can seed new verticals.** Customers who saved are the best renters and home prospects.	Cross-sell attach rate for customers with savings vs. without

Metrics I would put on one dashboard

- **Renewal retention** by cohort, login method, and carrier (primary health metric).
- **Account recovery success rate** and time to regain access.
- **Referral funnel:** invites sent, quotes started, policies bound, and the viral coefficient (new customers per customer).
- **Price-trust signals:** quote-to-bind by carrier and post-quote drop-off.
- **Between-renewal engagement:** monthly actives, driving-score opt-outs, and cross-sell attach rate.

One experiment to run first: referral at the moment of savings

Design: right after a customer binds a policy that saves money, show "You're saving about $X a year. Share Jerry with a friend" with a tracked link (treatment) vs. today's experience (control). Randomize at the user level.

Primary metric: referred policies bound per 100 new customers. **Guardrails:** app rating, opt-outs, and bind-flow completion.

Sample size (illustrative): if 2% of new customers send a working invite today, detecting a lift to 3% at 95% confidence and 80% power needs about **3,800 customers per arm**. At Jerry's scale, that is days, not months.

SQL sketch: does login method affect renewal? (assumed schema, ClickHouse)

```
SELECT u.login_method,
       count()                                  AS policies_due,
       countIf(p.renewed_with_jerry = 1)        AS renewed,
       round(renewed / policies_due, 3)         AS renewal_rate,
       countIf(a.failed_logins > 0)             AS had_failed_logins
FROM policies AS p
INNER JOIN users AS u ON u.user_id = p.user_id
LEFT JOIN (
    SELECT user_id, countIf(event = 'login_failed') AS failed_logins
    FROM app_events
    WHERE event_date BETWEEN '2026-07-01' AND '2026-09-30'
    GROUP BY user_id
) AS a ON a.user_id = p.user_id
WHERE p.term_end_date BETWEEN '2026-07-01' AND '2026-09-30'
GROUP BY u.login_method
ORDER BY renewal_rate;
```

Recommendation: what I would do in the first 30 days

- **Fix access first (H1).** Add email or backup-number login and prompt users to confirm contact details 30 days before renewal. It is low-cost and directly protects renewal revenue.
- **Launch the savings-moment referral test (H4)** to turn "it's cheap" into a tracked, rewarded action.
- **Size the price-trust gap (H2)** before acting on it, since direct quotes may differ because of discounts or coverage choices.
- **Use savings as the bridge to new verticals (H5):** offer renters or home quotes at renewal to customers who already saved.
- **Track AI assistants as a channel.** This customer found Jerry through ChatGPT, so it is worth measuring how many others do.

I would welcome the chance to test these hypotheses with real data. *Riya Gupta | guptariya471@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/riyaguptx*